

- 1. According to the article, "A Global Enigma Called TikTok", a) what does the name "TikTok" symbolically represent, b) what does its large library contain, and c) what is one of the reasons for TikTok's success?**

“TikTok” represents the sound made by a clock. This matches with the theme of short-form videos. The library contains clips of popular songs, TV show snippets, sounds from edited portions of videos of other TikTokers or YouTube videos. One reason for its success is how easy it is to create content. It has a low barrier for entry.

- 2. According to the article, "A Global Enigma Called TikTok", is TikTok different from other social media apps? If so, how? Explain.**

TikTok is driven by machine learning rather than a typical recommendation engine. It also has a deep marketing strategy that helps creators grow. There is also a deeper level of sound integration in the content which is driven by the large sound library and easy editing tools. It is also designed to facilitate low effort consumption that becomes addictive.

- 3. According to the article, "TikTok Bans Explained...", a) what are the 6 reasons the U.S. wanted to ban TikTok and b) which reason resonates most with you? Why? Explain in one paragraph.**

The 6 reasons for the U.S. wanting to ban TikTok are addictiveness, misinformation, children safety, mental health, selling data, and data security. The one that resonates most with me is misinformation. Truth and lies are not treated equally online. Absurd lies that make jaws drop get the most exposure and get spread much faster than the truth. The more people see

misinformation, the more people will believe it to be true. It's concerning to see how many people go to TikTok for trusted information when it's really just free game for anyone to spread falsehoods. I am not on TikTok but I see things being spread on other platforms that turn out to be false and I can only imagine it spreads much quicker on TikTok.

4. The U.S. is not the only country who wanted to ban or banned TikTok.

According to the article, "A Global Enigma Called TikTok", why was TikTok banned in a) Indonesia, b) Bangladesh, and c) India?

TikTok was banned in Indonesia because they claimed that the videos of creators in revealing outfits were inappropriate for their children. Bangladesh banned it because they were cracking down on pornography, and TikTok was one of the many websites they blocked. India banned it because they saw it as a threat to national security and sovereignty.

5. The deadline to find a U.S. buyer for TikTok has been extended for another 75 days. If a U.S. buyer doesn't materialize and TikTok was banned from the U.S., would you care? Why or why not? Explain in one paragraph. (If you reported TikTok use from your phone experiment last week, this may help you answer this question!)

For the most part, I do not care if TikTok gets banned. I do not use it although I just have the app just in case friends send me a video and I have to watch it. I do think that there would be a cultural difference after it gets banned if that happens. I always saw TikTok as a social and

cultural catalyst that sped up the reach of ideas. So many memes and trends in general came from TikTok, and I think we may not get as much of those if it were to get banned. There are other platforms with similar short-form videos, such as YouTube Shorts and Instagram Reels, but they do not have the same reach as TikTok. I am totally fine scrolling through those platforms, so I don't really care if it gets banned.